DR ACHYUTA SAMANTA, 58

Founder, Kalinga Institute of Industrial Technology and Kalinga Institute of Social Sciences

Bhubaneswar



A BETTER FUTURE Dr Achyuta Samanta with the students of KISS

SUBIR HALDER

May His *Tribe Grow*

The Kalinga institutes in Odisha impart education to around 30,000 tribal children, starting from kindergarten to post-graduation, free of cost

By **ROMITA DATTA**

Founded in 1993, the Kalinga Institute of Social Sciences (KISS), the first-ever exclusive tribal university in the world, has nurtured over 60,000 tribal children. Over the past three decades, Dr Achyuta Samanta, the founder of KISS and Kalinga Institute of Industrial Technology (KIIT), founded in 1992, has learnt how to encourage a thirst for knowledge among children. KISS offers classes to students across levels and KIIT is now counted as among some of the most acclaimed universities in professional education.

Having grown up in similar, difficult circumstances in Kalarabanka village of Odisha, Samanta is no stranger to the hardships faced by the students studying at KISS. After losing his father at the age of four, Samanta gave tuitions to fund his and his six siblings' education, and did menial jobs in his free time to help his mother keep the house running. He earned a distinction in his intermediate examination and, after